MIL-C-46937B(MU)
5 July 1973
SUPERSEDING
MIL-C-46937A(MU)
15 May 1964

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CARTRIDGE, CALIBER .45, BLANK, M9

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers a cartridge intended for saluting and training purposes.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

Military

MIL-I-45607	- Inspection Equipment, Acquisition, Maintenance and Disposition Of

STANDARDS

Military

MIL-STD-105	- Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-109	- Quality Assurance Terms and Definitions
MIL-STD-636	- Visual Inspection Standards for Small Arms Ammunition Through Caliber .50
MIL-STD-644	- Visual Inspection Standards and Inspection Procedures for Inspection of Packaging, Packing and Marking of Small Arms Ammunition
MIL-STD-1168	- Lot Numbering of Ammunition

DRAWINGS

Munitions Command

C10523085	- Cartridge, Caliber .45, Blank, M9
D7553728	- Packing & Marking for Cartridges, Caliber .45; Cartons; Box, Ammunition, M2A1; Box, Wirebound

FSC 1305

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2.1 (Cont'd)

PUBLICATIONS

AMCR 715-505, Vol. 5 - Ammunition Ballistic Acceptance Test Methods, Volume 3, Test Procedures for Cal. .45 Cartridges

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 General.-The cartridges shall comply with the requirements specified on drawing C10523085, referenced specifications and the following:

3.2 Screen perforation.-The cartridge, when fired, shall not cause perforations of 0.1 inch or greater in diameter in a paper screen placed 15 feet from the muzzle of the gun.

3.3 Function and casualty.-The cartridge shall function without casualty.

3.4 Workmanship.-The cartridge shall comply with the applicable drawing and shall be free of folds, deep draw scratches, scaly metal, corrosion, discoloration, dirt, oil and smears of lacquer.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection.-Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection r equirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Quality assurance terms and definitions.-Reference shall be made to MIL-STD-109 for definition of quality assurance terms.

4.2 First article sample.

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4.2.1 Initial production sample.-At the beginning of regular production a sample shall be submitted in accordance with contract requirements and shall consist of 1000 blank cartridges. The sample shall be manufactured using the same materials, equipment, processes and procedures as will be used in regular production. All parts and materials, including packaging and packing shall be the same as used for regular production and shall be obtained from the same source of supply.

4.2.1.1 Examination and test.-After inspection and provisional acceptance at source, the sample shall be inspected for all requirements of the drawings and specifications at a government laboratory or such other facility specified in the contract.

4.2.1.2 Initial production sample failure.-Failure of the sample to comply with requirements of the drawings and specifications shall result in sample disapproval. Determination as to acceptability of any initial production sample shall be based upon results of initial tests only, and no second sample shall be permitted on that initial production sample.

4.3 Inspection provisions.

4.3.1 Lot.

4.3.1.1 Submission of product.-The product shall be submitted in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.3.1.2 Lot identification.-Each lot of ammunition shall be identified as to type, caliber and model, as well as with a lot number in accordance with MIL-STD-1168. Each lot shall be further identified by a Federal Stock Number assigned by the procuring activity.

4.3.2 Examination.-Examination for major and minor defects shall be performed on a class basis in accordance with the classification of defects, Table I, using applicable sampling plans and acceptance criteria of MIL-STD-105. The acceptable quality level (AQL) for the major class shall be 0.65 per cent and the AQL for the minor class shall be 2.50 percent. All non-conforming cartridges shall be rejected.

4.3.2.1 Classification of defects.-The classification of defects shall be as specified in Table I.

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Table I

No.	Defect and Method of Inspection	Major	Minor
	Visual 1/		
1	Discolored, dirty, oily, smeared lacquer		X
2	Corroded or stained, if etched		X
7	Perforated case 2/	X	
8	Deep draw scratch		X
11	Scaly metal		X
16	Defective head		X
26	No primer	X	
27	Cocked primer	X	
28	Inverted primer	X	
29	Loose primer	X	
32	Fold		X
33	Missing wad	X	
34	Wad and joint between neck and wad not completely covered by lacquer		X
35	Opening between wad and case wall 2/	X	
	Gaging		
36	Failure to chamber in max. profile and alignment gage	X	
37	High primer	X	
38	Low primer		X

1/ Refer to MIL-STD-636 (caliber .45, section) for visual defect standards for defects 1 through 29. In the event of conflict between Table I of this specification and MIL-STD-636 as to defect classification, the classification specified in Table I shall apply.

2/ To be counted as a minor if no propellant can be shaken from the case.

4.3.3 Tests.-The tests listed in Table II shall be conducted in accordance with the methods and procedures specified in 4.4.

4.3.3.1 Test samples.-The quantities for the various tests shall be as specified in Table II. Only cartridges having met the visual and dimensional requirements shall be used in the ballistic tests, and shall have been selected in such a manner that the sample is representative of the entire lot. The cartridges shall be thoroughly mixed before being divided into samples for the various tests.

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4.3.3.1 (Cont'd)

Table II

Test	Number of Cartridges	Requirement Paragraph
Screen perforation 1/	196	3.2
Function and casualty 2/	308	3.3

1/ Failure of nineteen or more cartridges to comply with the applicable requirement shall be cause for rejection of the lot. If more than seven but less than nineteen cartridges fail in the first test, a second sample consisting of double the number of cartridges in the first sample shall be tested. The lot shall be rejected if in the combined first and second samples nineteen or more cartridges fail to comply with the applicable requirement.

2/ The lot shall be rejected when function and casualty defects plus all other firing defects exceed the acceptance number for the cumulative sample in Table III. If the number of defects found in the initial test exceeds the acceptance number for the first sample but is equal to or less than the acceptance number for the cumulative sample, a second sample consisting of double the quantities specified under function and casualty test, shall be fired in the service weapon specified therefor. If the total number of defects in the combined first and second sample exceeds the acceptance number for the cumulative sample, the lot shall be rejected. If, in testing a second sample, defects other than those for which the second sample is being tested should occur to the extent that they exceed the acceptance number for the cumulative sample, the lot shall be rejected.

4.3.3.2 Firing defects.-Firing defects and acceptance numbers shall be as specified in Table III.

Table III

Defects	Acceptance Number: First Sample	Acceptance Number: Cumulative (First & Second Sample)
Primer leak		
a. Escape of gas through or around primer cup	20	52

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4.3.3.2 (Cont'd)

Table III (Cont'd)

Defects	Acceptance Number	
	First Sample	Cumulative (First & Second Sample)
b. Primer remains in pocket but is physically loose	3	7
c. Blown primer	0	1
d. Primer falls out of pocket on retraction of bolt	0	1
Case casualties		
Splits, mouth or mouth taper 1/	20	52
Splits, body	7	18
Splits, through head	2	4
Complete rupture	0	1
Detached metal 2/	0	1
Failure to extract 3/	20	52
Misfire	6	14

1/ Only splits extending through the mouth taper more than .23 inches from mouth shall be penalized.

2/ Any particle of metal which becomes separated from the case between the mouth and the juncture of the mouth taper and the case shall be classified as detached metal.

3/ All failures to extract attributable to the ammunition, with the exception of complete rupture, observed in all tests shall be included.

4.3.4 Packaging, packing and marking inspection.-During or immediately prior to the packaging operation, 100 per cent examination of the cartridges shall be performed to ascertain that the cartridge type conforms to the drawing. Occurrence of a dummy or line throwing cartridge shall be classed as a major defect. Occurrence of any type other than those listed shall be classed as a critical defect. All nonconforming cartridges shall be rejected. Inspection for packaging, packing and marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-644 as applicable to the drawing.

4.3.5 Inspection equipment.-Except as otherwise provided for by the contract, the contractor shall supply and maintain inspection equipment in accordance with the applicable requirements of MIL-I-45607.

4.4 Test methods and procedures.

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4.4.1 Screen perforation.-The test shall be conducted in accordance with AMCR 715-505, Volume 5. Two pistols shall be used and one half of the quantity of cartridges specified in Table II shall be fired single shot in each pistol.

4.4.3 Defect penalty.-In any ballistic test, except function and casualty, in which the occurrence of a firing defect prevents the obtaining of a reliable result for the characteristic being tested, an additional shot shall be fired. That particular test shall not be penalized, but the acceptance sample shall be penalized for such defects in accordance with Table III.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packing.-Level A - The cartridges shall be packed in accordance with Drawing D7553728 (Worldwide shipment) or as required by the contract.

5.2 Marking and labeling.-Packing boxes shall be marked and labeled in accordance with the applicable drawing cited in 5.1.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data.-Invitation for bids, request for proposal, contracts or orders will specify the following:

6.1.1 Title, number and date of this specification.

6.1.2 Provision for the supply, maintenance and disposition of mandatory ballistic test equipment.

6.1.3 Provision for the submission of acceptance inspection reports containing final inspection results for each lot of ammunition presented to the Government.

6.2 Hazard notice.-The cartridge described herein and certain of its components are flammable and/or explosive and consequently present hazards in manufacture, handling, storage and shipment. The contractor should recognize these hazards and take appropriate measures to guard and protect against fire, explosion, adverse environment, corrosive atmosphere, rough handling and electrically induced incidents.

Custodian:

Army - MU

Preparing Activity:

Army - MU(FA)

Project No. 1305-A738

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: The purpose of this form is to solicit beneficial comments which will help achieve procurement of suitable products at reasonable cost and minimum delay, or will otherwise enhance use of the document. DoD contractors, government activities, or manufacturers/ vendors who are prospective suppliers of the product are invited to submit comments to the government. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements. Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity.

DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE

MIL-C-46937B(MU) Cartridge, Caliber .45, Blank, M9

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*

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